

GED Social Studies Practice Test 1

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC1-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city council is considering a rule that would require all council meetings to be announced at least one week in advance. The rule would also require meeting agendas to be posted online before the meeting begins. Supporters argue that residents cannot participate meaningfully if they do not know what officials plan to discuss.

Which civic principle is most directly supported by this proposal?

- A) Judicial review
- B) Transparency in government
- C) Federal supremacy
- D) Separation of powers

GED-SOC1-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A civics textbook explains that the Framers divided federal authority among three branches. Congress makes laws, the president carries out laws, and federal courts interpret laws. The same textbook notes that each branch has ways to limit the others.

Which statement best explains why this system was created?

- A) To allow state governments to control all federal decisions
- B) To make sure the president can act without delay
- C) To prevent any one branch from gaining too much power
- D) To remove courts from political disputes

GED-SOC1-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1760s and 1770s, many colonists objected to British taxes passed after the French and Indian War. They argued that Parliament had no right to tax them because the colonies did not elect representatives to Parliament. British officials answered that the taxes helped pay for defending the colonies.

Which issue was at the center of this disagreement?

- A) Whether colonists should be allowed to move west

- B) Whether taxation required political representation
- C) Whether Britain should end trade with the colonies
- D) Whether the colonies should create a national bank

GED-SOC1-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town tracked the average price of a basic grocery basket.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Average price: \$80, \$88, \$96

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Prices decreased each year.
- B) The grocery basket became more expensive over time.
- C) The price stayed the same from 2021 to 2023.
- D) The grocery basket cost twice as much in 2023 as in 2021.

GED-SOC1-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A school district holds a public meeting before changing its student transportation policy. Residents may speak for two minutes, submit written comments, or email the board before the vote.

Which TWO actions are examples of civic participation in this situation?

- A) Speaking during the public comment period
- B) Waiting for officials to decide without giving input
- C) Emailing the school board about the policy
- D) Ignoring the issue because it affects only students
- E) Refusing to follow the policy after it passes

GED-SOC1-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A coastal region has experienced stronger storms and repeated flooding. Local officials are considering building higher sea walls, restoring wetlands, and limiting construction in the most flood-prone areas.

Which geographic concept is most clearly shown in this scenario?

- A) Human-environment interaction
- B) Cultural diffusion

- C) Absolute monarchy
- D) Specialization of labor

GED-SOC1-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

The First Amendment protects freedom of speech, religion, press, assembly, and petition. These protections limit the ability of government to punish people for expressing views or practicing religion peacefully.

Which conclusion is best supported by this information?

- A) Individual liberties are protected from certain government actions.
- B) Citizens may ignore laws they disagree with.
- C) State governments may cancel federal rights.
- D) The president may decide which rights apply.

GED-SOC1-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city's unemployment rate was 5% last year and 7% this year. By how many percentage points did the unemployment rate increase?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC1-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the early 1800s, reformers campaigned for public schools, prison reform, and better treatment of people with mental illness. Many reformers argued that society could be improved through education, moral action, and changes to public institutions.

Which broader idea best connects these reform movements?

- A) Citizens and governments could work to improve society.
- B) Westward expansion should be stopped immediately.
- C) Political parties should be eliminated.
- D) Industrial production should be replaced by farming.

GED-SOC1-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The power to declare war belongs to [D1], while the power to command the armed forces belongs to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) Congress | the Supreme Court | state governors

D2) the president | Congress | the Supreme Court

GED-SOC1-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county election office reported the following turnout.

Age group: 18–29, 30–44, 45–64, 65+

Eligible voters: 20,000, 25,000, 30,000, 15,000

Voters who cast ballots: 8,000, 12,500, 18,000, 10,500

Which age group had the highest voter turnout rate?

A) 18–29

B) 30–44

C) 45–64

D) 65+

GED-SOC1-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region recorded the following population changes.

Year: 2000, 2010, 2020

Urban population: 1.2 million, 1.7 million, 2.4 million

Rural population: 2.0 million, 1.8 million, 1.5 million

Which conclusion is best supported by the table?

A) The rural population grew faster than the urban population.

B) The urban population increased while the rural population decreased.

C) The total population remained unchanged.

D) Urban and rural populations were equal in 2020.

GED-SOC1-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state law conflicts with a federal law on the same issue. A judge rules that the federal law

controls because the Constitution and federal laws made under it are the “supreme Law of the Land.”

Which constitutional principle is the judge applying?

- A) Popular sovereignty
- B) Federal supremacy
- C) Due process
- D) Judicial restraint

GED-SOC1-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

After the Civil War, the Reconstruction Amendments abolished slavery, defined national citizenship, promised equal protection under the law, and prohibited denying the vote based on race. These amendments changed the relationship between the federal government and the states.

Which statement best describes one effect of the Reconstruction Amendments?

- A) They expanded federal protection of civil rights.
- B) They ended all political conflict in the South.
- C) They gave states complete control over citizenship.
- D) They created the first national income tax.

GED-SOC1-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A factory owner can use a limited budget to buy either a new machine or additional advertising. The machine would increase production, while advertising might increase sales. The owner chooses the machine.

What is the opportunity cost of this decision?

- A) The money already spent on the factory building
- B) The additional advertising the owner gave up
- C) The total number of workers at the factory
- D) The price customers pay for the product

GED-SOC1-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the late 1800s, many Americans moved to cities as factories expanded. Cities offered jobs,

transportation networks, and access to markets, but they also faced crowding, pollution, and housing shortages.

Which TWO developments were effects of industrialization and urban growth?

- A) Growth of wage labor in factories
- B) Immediate disappearance of poverty in cities
- C) Expansion of urban housing and transportation needs
- D) Elimination of immigration to the United States
- E) End of all labor organizing

GED-SOC1-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A person accused of a crime must be informed of the charges, have the chance to hear evidence, and be allowed to respond before being punished. Courts must follow fair procedures rather than act arbitrarily.

Which constitutional protection is described?

- A) Due process
- B) Eminent domain
- C) Executive privilege
- D) Direct democracy

GED-SOC1-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A manufacturing company designs products in one country, buys parts from three other countries, assembles the final product in another country, and sells it worldwide.

Which trend does this example best illustrate?

- A) Isolationism
- B) Globalization
- C) Subsistence farming
- D) Constitutional federalism

GED-SOC1-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A governor vetoes a bill passed by the state legislature. The legislature then votes again and overrides the veto by the required supermajority.

Which principle is illustrated by this process?

- A) Checks and balances
- B) Trial by jury
- C) Judicial review
- D) Naturalization

GED-SOC1-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city's population increased from 80,000 to 100,000 over ten years. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC1-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A store sells 500 winter coats in December. In January, the store lowers the price and sells 650 coats.

What is the increase in the number of coats sold?

- A) 100 coats
- B) 150 coats
- C) 500 coats
- D) 650 coats

GED-SOC1-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A person writes a letter to a senator asking for support for a veterans' benefits bill. This is an example of [D1] and is protected by the right to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) civic participation | judicial review | federalism

D2) petition the government | quarter soldiers | issue currency

GED-SOC1-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A New Deal supporter argued that during an economic emergency, the federal government had a responsibility to create jobs, stabilize banks, and provide relief to people who could not find work.

Source B:

A New Deal critic argued that too much federal spending could increase government power and create dependence on public programs.

What was the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether the Great Depression happened
- B) Whether the federal government should take a large role in economic relief
- C) Whether banks existed before the New Deal
- D) Whether workers should be allowed to move between states

GED-SOC1-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A federal court reviews a law passed by Congress and decides that the law violates the Constitution. The court refuses to enforce the law.

Which power is the court using?

- A) Legislative veto
- B) Judicial review
- C) Executive order
- D) Popular referendum

GED-SOC1-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Federalism
- B) Separation of powers
- C) Popular sovereignty
- D) Rule of law

Targets:

- T1) Government authority is divided between national and state governments.
- T2) Government leaders and citizens are both subject to the law.
- T3) Government power ultimately comes from the people.

GED-SOC1-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state budget lists the following planned spending.

Program: Education, Transportation, Public Safety, Health Services

Spending: \$4.2 billion, \$1.6 billion, \$1.1 billion, \$3.1 billion

Which program receives the largest amount of planned spending?

- A) Education
- B) Transportation
- C) Public Safety
- D) Health Services

GED-SOC1-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

The rule of law means that laws must be applied fairly and that government officials cannot act as if they are above the law. Courts, written laws, and public procedures help limit arbitrary power.

Which situation best reflects the rule of law?

- A) A mayor ignores traffic laws because of the mayor's position.
- B) A court hears evidence before deciding whether an official broke the law.
- C) A legislature cancels elections during a budget debate.
- D) A police department punishes a person without a hearing.

GED-SOC1-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

During the Progressive Era, journalists and reformers drew attention to unsafe working conditions, political corruption, and problems in food production. Some reforms led to new regulations, expanded public oversight, and changes in election laws.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Progressive reformers sought to address problems caused by industrial society.
- B) Progressive reformers wanted to end all federal regulation.
- C) The Progressive Era focused only on foreign policy.
- D) The Progressive Era eliminated disagreement over government power.

GED-SOC1-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A farming region depends heavily on one river for irrigation. During a long drought, farms use more groundwater, crop yields fall, and nearby towns debate water restrictions.

Which cause-and-effect relationship is most clearly shown?

- A) Water scarcity can affect agriculture and community decisions.
- B) Industrialization always reduces the need for water.
- C) Migration ends when droughts occur.
- D) Rivers have no effect on settlement patterns.

GED-SOC1-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state legislative committee held hearings on a public safety bill.

Group: Residents, Business owners, Local officials, Advocacy organizations

Number of speakers: 18, 9, 7, 16

How many total speakers testified at the hearings?

- A) 34
- B) 40
- C) 50
- D) 60

GED-SOC1-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A citizen who is called for jury duty reports to court, listens to instructions, and serves if selected. The citizen does not work for the government but still helps the legal system function.

Which idea does this example best illustrate?

- A) Civic responsibility
- B) Judicial appointment
- C) Executive privilege
- D) Interstate commerce

GED-SOC1-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A news article explains that voter registration rules are set by states, but states must still follow federal constitutional protections and federal voting rights laws.

Which TWO statements are supported by this explanation?

- A) States have a role in managing elections.
- B) States may violate federal voting protections whenever they choose.
- C) Federal law can limit state election rules.
- D) The Supreme Court counts every ballot directly.
- E) Voting rules are unrelated to federalism.

GED-SOC1-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A town has only enough tax revenue this year to repair roads or build a new public library wing. Officials choose road repairs because several bridges need urgent maintenance.

Which statement best describes the economic reasoning in this decision?

- A) Public choices often involve trade-offs because resources are limited.
- B) Governments never face scarcity.
- C) Tax revenue can be used only for transportation.
- D) Opportunity cost applies only to businesses.

GED-SOC1-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A historian compares union membership in one industry.

Year: 1930, 1940, 1950

Union members: 20,000, 85,000, 120,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Union membership decreased after 1930.
- B) Union membership increased from 1930 to 1950.
- C) Union membership stayed the same in each year.
- D) Union membership was lower in 1950 than in 1940.

GED-SOC1-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A public official argues, "A free press helps voters learn what government is doing. Reporters may make mistakes, but allowing officials to punish criticism would make it harder for citizens to hold leaders accountable."

Which claim is best supported by the official's argument?

- A) Freedom of the press supports government accountability.
- B) Government officials should approve all newspaper stories before publication.
- C) Elections are unnecessary when newspapers exist.
- D) The press has no role in a democratic society.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC1-001 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Transparency in government — Explanation: Posting meeting notices and agendas helps residents see and understand government activity.

GED-SOC1-002 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: To prevent any one branch from gaining too much power — Explanation: Separation of powers and checks and balances are designed to limit concentrated power.

GED-SOC1-003 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Whether taxation required political representation — Explanation: The source describes colonists objecting to taxes because they lacked elected representatives in Parliament.

GED-SOC1-004 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The grocery basket became more expensive over time. — Explanation: The average price increased from \$80 to \$88 to \$96.

GED-SOC1-005 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Speaking during the public comment period | Emailing the school board about the policy — Explanation: Both actions involve residents communicating with public officials about a policy decision.

GED-SOC1-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Human-environment interaction — Explanation: The scenario shows people responding to environmental risks such as flooding and storms.

GED-SOC1-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Individual liberties are protected from certain government actions. — Explanation: The First Amendment protects several freedoms by limiting government power over expression and religion.

GED-SOC1-008 — Correct: 2 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 2 — Explanation: The unemployment rate increased from 5% to 7%, a change of 2 percentage points.

GED-SOC1-009 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Citizens and governments could work to improve society. — Explanation: The source connects reform movements through the belief that institutions and society could be improved.

GED-SOC1-010 — Correct: D1=Congress; D2=the president — Correct Answer: D1=Congress; D2=the president — Explanation: Congress declares war, while the president serves as commander in chief.

GED-SOC1-011 — Correct: D — Correct Answer: 65+ — Explanation: Turnout rates are 40%, 50%, 60%, and 70%; the 65+ group has the highest rate.

GED-SOC1-012 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The urban population increased while the rural population decreased. — Explanation: Urban population rose from 1.2 million to 2.4 million, while rural population fell from 2.0 million to 1.5 million.

GED-SOC1-013 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Federal supremacy — Explanation: The Supremacy Clause gives valid federal law priority over conflicting state law.

GED-SOC1-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: They expanded federal protection of civil rights. — Explanation: The Reconstruction Amendments addressed slavery, citizenship, equal protection, and voting rights.

GED-SOC1-015 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: The additional advertising the owner gave up — Explanation: Opportunity cost is the next-best alternative that is not chosen.

GED-SOC1-016 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Growth of wage labor in factories | Expansion of urban housing and transportation needs — Explanation: Industrialization increased factory work and created new urban infrastructure needs.

GED-SOC1-017 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Due process — Explanation: Due process requires fair legal procedures before government can punish a person.

GED-SOC1-018 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Globalization — Explanation: The example shows international production, supply chains, and worldwide markets.

GED-SOC1-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Checks and balances — Explanation: A veto and veto override show branches limiting or checking each other's power.

GED-SOC1-020 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: The increase is 20,000; 20,000 divided by 80,000 equals 25%.

GED-SOC1-021 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: 150 coats — Explanation: Sales increased from 500 to 650 coats, a difference of 150.

GED-SOC1-022 — Correct: D1=civic participation; D2=petition the government — Correct Answer: D1=civic participation; D2=petition the government — Explanation: Contacting a senator about legislation is civic participation and is protected by the right to petition.

GED-SOC1-023 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Whether the federal government should take a large role in economic relief — Explanation: Source A supports federal action, while Source B warns against expanded federal power and spending.

GED-SOC1-024 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Judicial review — Explanation: Judicial review is the power of courts to decide whether laws violate the Constitution.

GED-SOC1-025 — Correct: T1=A; T2=D; T3=C — Correct Answer: T1=Federalism; T2=Rule of law; T3=Popular sovereignty — Explanation: Federalism divides national and state power, rule of law subjects everyone to law, and popular sovereignty means power comes from the people.

GED-SOC1-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Education — Explanation: Education receives \$4.2 billion, the largest amount listed.

GED-SOC1-027 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: A court hears evidence before deciding whether an official broke the law. — Explanation: The rule of law requires officials to be accountable under fair legal procedures.

GED-SOC1-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Progressive reformers sought to address problems caused by industrial society. — Explanation: The source describes reforms responding to unsafe work, corruption, and food production problems.

GED-SOC1-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Water scarcity can affect agriculture and community decisions. — Explanation: The drought reduces crop yields and leads towns to debate water restrictions.

GED-SOC1-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 50 — Explanation: $18 + 9 + 7 + 16 = 50$ speakers.

GED-SOC1-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Civic responsibility — Explanation: Jury duty is a responsibility through which citizens help the justice system operate.

GED-SOC1-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: States have a role in managing elections. | Federal law can limit state election rules. — Explanation: The statement describes election administration as shared between state authority and federal protections.

GED-SOC1-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public choices often involve trade-offs because resources are limited. — Explanation: The town must choose between two uses for limited tax revenue.

GED-SOC1-034 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Union membership increased from 1930 to 1950. — Explanation: Membership rose from 20,000 in 1930 to 120,000 in 1950.

GED-SOC1-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Freedom of the press supports government accountability. — Explanation: The source argues that a free press helps citizens monitor and hold leaders accountable.